

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

PART A Group Interaction

This article was published recently on a business website:

A hot social media site among teens is one people might not expect

If you were trying to guess which social media sites are becoming popular among teenagers, what would you choose? Snapchat? Instagram? Facebook?

You might be surprised to learn that a growing number of high schoolers are now turning to a site that is all about success at work: LinkedIn.

The world's largest online professional network, LinkedIn, helps people find the right jobs, connect with others in their field, make important professional connections and learn skills necessary for career success. It also allows users to join career-related discussions and to read, and comment on, articles from their field.

According to recent studies, many teenagers in North America now see LinkedIn as the hottest social media platform. This is partly because they are trying to prepare themselves for today's fast-moving job market, but also because they like the positive tone of the site.

"When I go on Facebook, I just see people with horrible feelings and bad ideas," said one teenager. "And when I go on LinkedIn, it's so positive and honest—this is how social media should be."

Many secondary students also say that they like LinkedIn because it helps them to find role models, to follow their interests, and to learn about possible future job trends.

"I had been interviewing teenagers about social media," said journalist Anya Kamenetz. "And I learned that this site is popular with those who are really focused on their futures."

Your class is talking about the growing popularity of LinkedIn among teens. Your group has been asked to discuss this trend. You may want to talk about:

- why teenagers may be turning away from other social media sites
- whether social media is useful for finding career information
- whether secondary school students should be concerned about their future careers
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. Do you use social media?
2. Which social media sites are most popular among teenagers?
3. What job would you like to do in the future?
4. Which careers are most popular among teenagers nowadays?
5. Would you look for jobs on social media?
6. How do people in Hong Kong usually look for jobs?
7. Would you post your profile on social media to find a job?
8. How can you check if information on social media is trustworthy?